

Coaches quick with quips

Comedian Jerry Clower, a Mississippi State rooster and former Bulldog player, wasn't on hand.

But the two head coaches, Emory Bellard of Mississippi State, and Tom Osborne of Nebraska, filled in nicely as an overflow crowd of 1,100 took in the festivities at the Chamber of Commerce Sun Bowl luncheon Friday afternoon.

In the yearly burlesque skits, Osborne was the target this year of alderman Polly Harris' lipstick-lacquered kisses. "It's nice to be at this high-class luncheon," quipped Osborne after being kissed fervently by the bewigged Mrs. Harris. "We were enjoying ourselves, up until five minutes ago."

Bellard missed the kisses. "I was waiting with great anticipation. Tom, I congratulate you. At least you're considered kissable here in El Paso."

Andy Cohen's invocation once again included special mention for CBS television commentators Tom Brookshier and Pat Summerall, that they make it to Saturday's game "clear-eyed and clear-headed."

Bellard noted he had never heard an invocation covering two individuals. "You could almost move around with reckless abandon," he said, addressing the pair doing their sixth Sun Bowl.

Nebraska wingback Anthony Steels and Mississippi State reserve running back Steve Packer entertained the crowd with song.